

September 11, 2026

Climate Reserve Hiring Team

Aspen Global Change Institute

RE: PROGRAM ASSOCIATE, CLIMATE RESERVE

Dear Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Program Associate role because Climate Reserve is doing something I've watched become necessary from several different angles of my career: building a backstop for climate expertise at the exact moment the public sector's ability to hold that expertise is being politically destabilized. I haven't personally been laid off from a federal climate role, but I've spent enough of my career adjacent to this infrastructure to feel its fragility directly. I spent three years inside the **National Park Service's** own science and mapping infrastructure, and three more at **Teren**, a geospatial-risk company whose work depended on **environmental regulatory processes for oil and gas infrastructure and national park boundary lines** holding steady.

When those processes get politically destabilized, the disruption reaches companies, contractors, and communities well beyond the federal agencies making headlines.

That Teren role is probably the closest analog in my background to this one: I worked on machine-learning models built from drone and satellite imagery to assess environmental risk on ambiguous or contested boundary lines — surface hydrology, habitat encroachment, invasive species — for oil and gas sites and land near national park boundaries. It's regulatory science translated into a decision someone actually has to make, which is the same translation work this role is built around.

I've also spent my career moving across workstreams and stakeholders rather than staying in one lane. At Lytics, I owned a multi-stakeholder enterprise engagement end-to-end, translating a technical data problem into something both engineering and business teams could act on. At Teren, I partnered daily across engineering, product, and sales on behalf of institutional customers. At Homebot, I hired and managed a technical team while translating findings for non-technical stakeholders. In each case I was the connective tissue between the technical work and the people who had to decide something because of it — the same cross-functional utility-player role this position is describing.

On the decision-support ecosystem itself: beyond NPS and Teren, I currently advise a startup building software for small water utilities — subnational climate-adaptation infrastructure, with all the slow procurement and regulatory caution that comes with it — and I hold a BA in Geography (GIS), with Honors, and a spatial-statistics thesis. I also own a Salesforce CRM stack from a past role, and I'm currently building AI-agent workflows as a startup advisor, which I'd bring directly to the coalition-tracking and knowledge-management systems this role maintains.

I'm based in Boulder and already spend time in the Roaring Fork Valley — I worked with a small business in Glenwood Springs this past year — so this region isn't unfamiliar to me. I'd welcome the chance to talk about how my background could support Climate Reserve's rescue and reinvention work.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO